

Chapter on the British Isles from Naked Steps: A Timeless Panoramic Ancestral Odyssey

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Abstract

Naked Steps: A Timeless Panoramic Ancestral Odyssey is a comprehensive work spanning every culture on earth, tracing the mythological, folkloric, and historical threads that connect humanity across time and geography. This chapter explores the mythological, folkloric, and historical tapestry of the British Isles, spanning from prehistoric settlement through the medieval period and into the early modern era. Beginning with the arrival of Proto-Britons upon ancient shores, the narrative traverses the landscapes of England, Wales, Scotland, and Ireland, uncovering the rich cultural traditions, legendary figures, and supernatural beliefs that shaped each region's distinct identity.

In England, dragon lore, medieval chronicles, and folk legends intertwine with documented historical accounts, from William of Newburgh's mysterious Green Children of Woolpit to the outlaw mythology of Robin Hood. Wales contributes its enduring poetic traditions, Arthurian legend, and the draconic chronicles of Nennius and Geoffrey of Monmouth. Scotland's Highland customs, royal histories, and creature mythology — including the enduring legend of Loch Ness — reflect a culture steeped in both pageantry and the supernatural. Ireland's Celtic seasonal traditions, monastic scholarship, pagan ritual, and a vast pantheon of mythological beings, from Tuatha Dé Danann to Kelpies, reveal a deeply layered spiritual and imaginative heritage.

Drawing on primary medieval sources including *Historia rerum Anglicarum*, *Historia Brittonum*, *Historia Regum Britanniae*, and the *Book of Kells*, this chapter presents the British Isles as a crucible of intersecting Norse, Germanic, Iberian, and Celtic influences, where history and myth exist in continuous dialogue.

Chapter on the British Isles from *Naked Steps: A Timeless Panoramic Ancestral Odyssey*

Proto-Britons stepped upon the shores into a mysterious fog. Above, low growls hummed from puffin-covered basalt cliffs. Further inland, an owl on an old oak tree branch heard a rustle in the thickets. Wild boar snouts exposed mushrooms, truffles, and acorns. In the underbrush, buttercups wiggled through the foliage. A primrose path opened onto gentle floral hills. Taunted by butterflies, a timid hare nuzzled against velvet violet petals.

On the way, stone henges, monoliths, and hominid footprints in the Cromer Forest-bed Formation sparked the sojourners' imagination. Long before iconic taxis, elegant high teas, and red telephone boxes, natural wonders lay hidden. Gough's Cave sheltered the skeleton of *Cheddar Man*, while plesiosaur fossils emerged along the Jurassic Coast.

British Isles

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England

Farmers, nobles, and blacksmiths battled worms in Lambton, Stockburn, and Bamborough. Quiet villagers transformed into dragon slayers in Wantley, Unsworth, Slingsby, and Longwitton. Heroes triumphed in Mordiford, Loschy, and Nine Maidens Well. Clad in metal armor, gallant knights shielded Brinsop and Christchurch.

In St. Martin's Land—a sunless twilight realm—lights and frequencies startled two shepherds. A brother and sister followed the spectacle through a tunnel into the wolf pits in Woolpit, Suffolk, England. Once under the protection of a knight, the christened, green-hued children spoke an unknown language and exclusively consumed broad beans. After the boy withered away, the girl entered English society and later married a man from King's Lynn. -*Historia rerum Anglicarum*, William of Newburgh, a historian from Newburgh Priory in Yorkshire, c. 1,189 CE.

Chronica Anglorum, written by Ralph, an abbot at Coggeshall Abbey in Essex, added to the original report with an account by the children's guardian, Sir Richard de Calne of Wykes Manor in Bardwell, c. 1,220 CE.

A note on Matthew Paris' map of Britain read, "*This part between the north and south (of Scotland) faces a vast sea (the Atlantic) where there is nothing except the dwelling place of monsters,*" c. 1,250 CE.

In a Middle Dutch version of the Perceval Cycle, the *Morien* poem described a knight. "*He was all black, even as I tell ye: his head, his body, and his hands were all black, saving only his teeth,*" c. 1,290 CE.

From the ashes of the Black Death, Merry Men—a band of outlaws in Sherwood Forest—and Maid Marian, Robin Hood fed paupers from prosperous pockets, pursued by the Sheriff of Nottingham.

The *Mowing Devil*, or *Strange News of Hertfordshire* published a woodcut pamphlet to describe cryptic circles pressed into crops on farms, c. 1,678 CE.

Cloaked in the murky alleyways of Whitechapel, a deadly specter, Jack the Ripper exposed the limits of Scotland Yard, c. 1,888 CE.

Wales

Legends from Taliesin, Llancarfan, and the Mabinogion developed timeless traditions, wedded to a legacy of poetry, 550-1,350 CE. Cadwaladr, King of Gwynedd, displayed a red dragon emblem symbolized on the Welsh flag, c. 655 CE. Dog-eared pages from the *Historia Brittonum*, by Welsh monk, Nennius, chronicled battles with dragons, worms, and serpents on the British Isles, c. 800 CE. In *Historia Regum Britanniae*, Geoffrey of Monmouth told of King Arthur and Queen Guinevere, the rulers of Camelot. The monarch presided over the Round Table, embarked on quests with knights, and Merlin, a wizard, wielded a magical sword, Caliburn, later *Excalibur*, c. 1,136 CE.

Scotland

Over the hills, Scots danced in tartan kilts and played the Great Highland bagpipes. Ancients crowned sovereigns with the *Stone of Destiny*, feasted on haggis, and sipped whisky—the water of life.

Encounters with creatures, selkie shapeshifters, the Linton Worm of Roxburghshire, and Nessie of Loch Ness swirled in the atmosphere.

King James VI of Scotland authored *Daemonologie*, c. 1,597 CE, enacted the *Witchcraft Act of 1,604*, and commissioned the *King James Bible*, c. 1,611 CE.

Ireland

Proto-Celts journeyed into vistas tinted in subtle mossy hues. Fauna pastured on fields of sweetgrass speckled with four-leaf clovers. In time, weather shifts led to seasonal observances—Samhain, Imbolc, Beltane, and Lughnasadh.

Pagans sacrificed humans by fire in wicker effigies and offered slaughtered bulls to the deity Tarvos Trigaranus. As novel chapters bounded forward, Saint Patrick baptized Irish druids, c. 432 CE. Monks preserved scriptures with images of eternal Celtic knots and golden zoomorphic designs in the *Book of Kells*, c. 800 CE.

Shrouded in Galway clouds, Hy-Brasil, a phantom island, appeared on explorers' logs and medieval maps, first recorded as *Bracile* by cartographer Angelino Dulcert, c. 1,325 CE. Warriors faced giants, Fomorians, dragons, Ollphéisteanna, and water horses, Kelpies.

Dramatic, wild, windswept cliffs whispered fairy tales from Norse, Germanic, Iberian, and Celtic origins. Leprechauns presented gold dipped in chicanery at the end of rainbows. Characterized as a bump in the night, the bogey or bogeyman created mischief and disturbed sleep. Sprites, hobgoblins, fays, lutins, and duendes served or sabotaged on a whim. Sidhe protected treasures, granted wishes, abducted children, and left changelings in cradles. With a rabbit's foot in hand, clurichauns haunted wine cellars and breweries amidst the pranks of imps, gremlins, goblins, and kobolds. Hobs rested comfortably in homes, trolls secluded beneath bridges, and knockers lived in mines. Adrift between dimensions, Tuatha Dé Danann and trows dwelled in mounds. Wise gnomes gardened by day and retreated underground by night.

A kiss away from the Blarney Stone, performers fiddled, step danced, and rhymed in limericks. After blight blackened crops of potatoes, a headless horseman, Dullahan rode with a human spine as a whip—an ominous omen, c. 1,845 CE.

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